



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*śrutvāpi śuddhacaitanyamātmānamatisundaram |
upasthe+atyantasamśakto mālinyamadhigacchati | 3 | 4 | |
sarvabhūteṣu cātmānaṃ sarvabhūtāni cātmani |
munerjānata āścaryaṃ mamatvamanuvartate | 3 | 5 | |
āsthitaḥ paramādvaitaṃ mokṣārthe+api vyavasthitaḥ |
āścaryaṃ kāmavaśago vikalaḥ keliśikṣayā | 3 | 6 | |*

— Aṣṭāvakraḡītā, Prakaraṇa 3 (Chapter 3), Verses 4-6

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Even after hearing of the pure, beautiful consciousness that is your true self, if you remain deeply attached to sensual pleasures, you allow impurities to cloud your perception. This isn't merely a physical act being criticized, but a state of mind. The Aṣṭāvakraḡītā is pointing to the irony of knowing the truth intellectually, yet still being enslaved by desires that pull you away from inner peace. It's like knowing the sun is shining, but choosing to remain indoors in the dark.

The next verse highlights another paradox: the sage who recognizes the Self in all beings, and all beings in the Self, yet astonishingly clings to possessiveness. How is it possible to grasp the interconnectedness of everything, the ultimate unity, and still be caught in the trap of "mine"? This shows us how deeply ingrained the ego is, how easily we can slip back into identifying with the limited self, even after profound realizations. It's a warning against complacency on the spiritual path.

Finally, the text describes someone who is established in the highest non-duality, even striving for liberation, yet is controlled by lust and confused by frivolous pursuits. The contradiction is stark. You might be diligently practicing meditation, studying scriptures, and intellectually understanding the nature of reality, but if you are still driven by uncontrolled desires, your efforts are undermined. This verse speaks to the importance of integrating your spiritual understanding with your daily life. It suggests a need for self-awareness and genuine transformation, not just intellectual assent. In modern life, we often compartmentalize our spirituality, keeping it separate from our relationships, careers, and everyday choices. The Aṣṭāvakraḡītā challenges you to live your truth fully, to embody your understanding of oneness in every aspect of your existence, from the grandest spiritual quest to the smallest daily interaction.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are there areas of your life where you intellectually understand a spiritual principle, but your actions contradict that understanding?